

CDN Incident Alert: 0071. TLP: CLEAR		Date
Title	PL Banned, Yet Broadcasting: Sanctioned Belarusian State Media Influencing the Polish Elections	31/05/2025

Summary

- Between January 15th and May 7th, Radio Belarus, a part of the sanctioned Belarusian state entity Beltelradio, has published videos interfering in the Polish Presidential elections via TikTok, YouTube, X, and Facebook. In December 2024, the pages were flagged to social media platforms as sanctioned entities still accessible in the EU. The Social media companies did not take down the pages, which made it possible for the sanctioned entity to try to interfere in the elections, potentially violating DSA Articles 34 and 35.
- Radio Belarus frequently releases videos designed to weaken trust in democratic institutions. A common focus is casting doubt on the fairness and transparency of Polish elections.
- Radio Belarus's Polish channels gained 16 million views across platforms and at least 542,000 interactions.
- The operation is creating localised content targeting Polish audiences and appropriating content from its Belarusian sister channels to discredit the legitimacy of the election and cultivate support for aligned candidates.
- The channels were once again reported to the platforms, leading to TikTok geofencing Radio Belarus.

Incident

Between January 15 and May 7, the Belarusian-sanctioned state-controlled media Radio Belarus published 51 YouTube videos, discrediting the legitimacy of the Polish Elections, repeatedly interviewing and promoting two presidential candidates, primarily Maciej Maciak.

On June 3, 2022, the EU adopted its sixth package of sanctions against Belarus, which [included](#) Belteleradio company, among the targeted entities. In August and September 2023, Radio Belarus channel — a [part](#) of Belteleradio — launched a Polish-language [YouTube](#) channel, followed by a Polish-language [Telegram](#) channel, an [account](#) on X and [TikTok](#). Radio Belarus has been expanding its presence on these platforms since 2023, and they target the Polish presidential elections in 2025. Despite a small follower base, X posts are disproportionately amplified, particularly among Polish-linked accounts.

Narrative

Meta-Narrative: Polish elections are not democratic and will be rigged.

Sub-Narratives: Brussels will try to annul the presidential elections through Polish Supreme Court; Local vote rigging may be difficult, but central manipulation of the vote count is still possible; Anti-establishment voices are silenced through limited media access, biased coverage, and exclusion from polls.

Impact

Reach: Since September 2023, Radio Belarus's Polish channels' content has amassed 16 million views across platforms and at least 542,000 interactions.

Outcome: N/A.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [T0139.001: Discourage](#) – The operation aims to undermining the legitimacy of the Polish election;

Objective: [T0136.005: Cultivate Support for Initiative](#) – The operation cultivating support for candidates that align with Belarus's interests.

[T0101: Create Localized Content](#) – The operation is translating content from Russian to Polish and creating original content for Polish audiences.

[T0084.004: Appropriate Content](#) – The entity is republishing content from its' sister channels, bringing it to Polish audiences.

[T0091.002: Recruit Partisans](#) – Radio Belarus has employed a criminal Polish citizen who's in exile in Belarus.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Action taken: Reported the channels to the social media companies – TikTok geofenced the channel.

Recommendations: Social media platforms must block access to Radio Belarus in the EU, improve detection of sanctioned entities, and work with civil society; The Polish and other EU governments should appoint sanctions coordinators to enforce and prosecute violations in collaboration with civil society.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
A4E DFRLab	Belarus	Upon Request	Givi Gigitashvili, DFRLab, Martyna Hoffman, Political Accountability Foundation, Saman Nazari, Alliance4Europe	TikTok, YouTube, Facebook, X.	